RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

15 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 3:55 PM, Thursday 15 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 397 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 84 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 5,430 minutes at 4:00 PM; Dammam moving again after 1:04–2:42 PM halt

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 5,430 minutes at 4:00 PM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 397 flights cancelled for Thursday (53% of scheduled).
- Coalition's 11:48 AM Madinah cruise-missile intercept remains the latest CONFIRMED attack; Houthis deny it (CLAIM, via AP).
- Dammam moving again after its 1:04–2:42 PM halt: 4 takeoffs and 7 landings 3:00–4:00 PM, latest landing XY740 from Abha at 3:48 PM.
- 84 Dammam flights cancelled today.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5426 min).

397	0/0	5
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

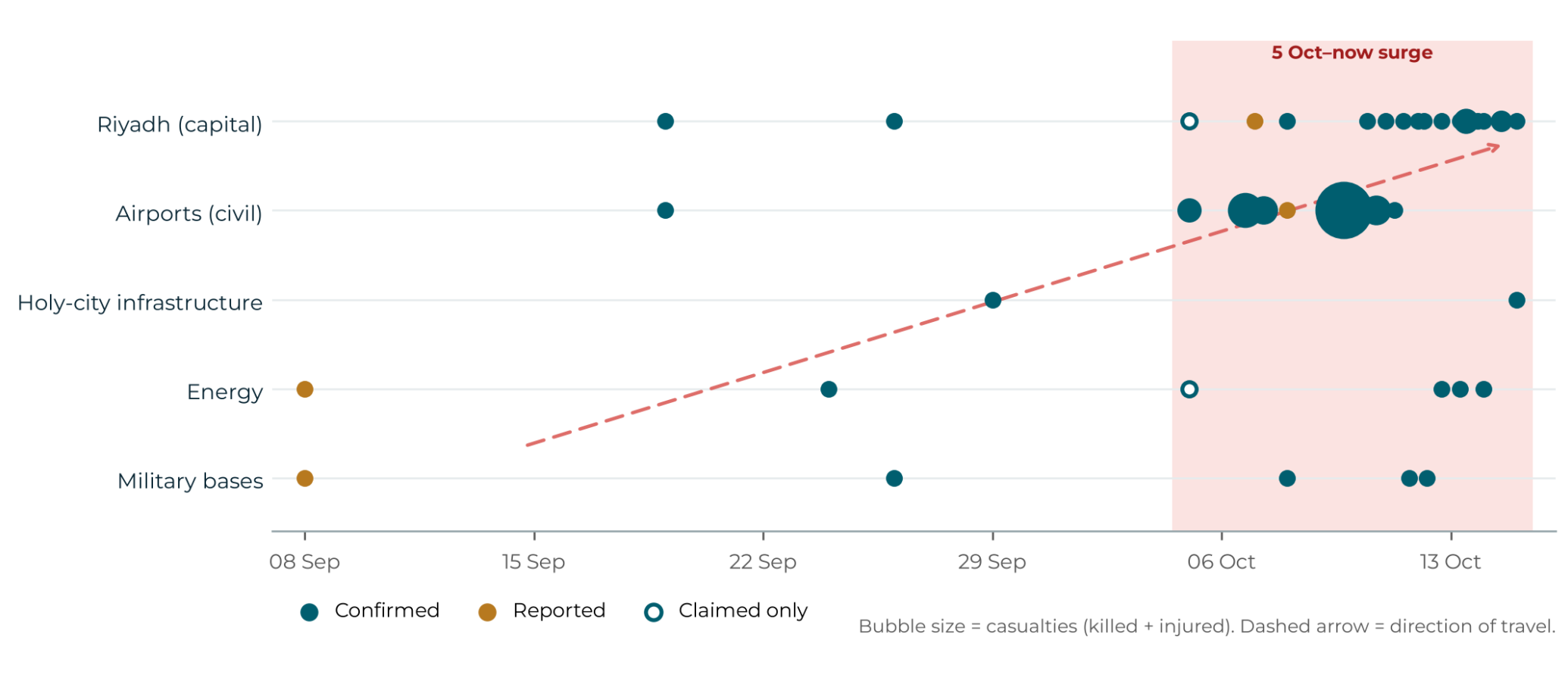
5 takeoffs and 8 landings in the last hour.

84	5/8	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (5,430 min at 4:00 PM). Dammam traffic resumed after its 1:04–2:42 PM halt: 4 takeoffs and 7 landings 3:00–4:00 PM. Houthi spokesman denies the Madinah cruise-missile attack (CLAIM, via AP); Coalition intercept at 11:48 AM remains the latest major CONFIRMED intercept. No new GACA or airport operations notice this hour.

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 15 OCT



39 sourced events since 8 September (33 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: cruise missile intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah region (15 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 3:00 PM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 2, interceptions 2, alerts 2, all-clears 2.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh still halted; Dammam halt 1:04–2:42 PM; Coalition downs cruise missile over Madinah (11:48 AM)

Checked at 3:58 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Prophet's Mosque imam Sheikh Dr. Salah Al-Budair condemns Houthi terrorist acts and backs the Kingdom's political and defensive measures; says targeting Makkah or Madinah targets all Muslims**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:49 PM** · published 3:49 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 3:58 PM

Prophet's Mosque imam Sheikh Dr. Salah Al-Budair: the Kingdom is a land of peace and Islam and servant of the Two Holy Mosques; we condemn the Houthi terrorist acts, stand behind the leadership and support the political and defensive measures the Kingdom has taken. Targeting Makkah or Madinah is not only targeting the Kingdom but all Muslims.

CLAIM **Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree denies carrying out the Madinah cruise-missile attack; coalition statement did not assign blame (AP)**

AP · **2:08 PM** · published 2:08 PM AST Thu 15 Oct; checked 3:58 PM

AP: the Saudi-led coalition said it intercepted and destroyed a cruise missile over Madinah province but did not assign blame; Houthi spokesman Brig. Gen. Yahya Saree denied carrying out the attack (Houthi claim, unverified).

CONFIRMED **Coalition: cruise missile intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **11:48 AM** · published 11:48 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition spokesman, Arabic, translated; relayed by SPA 11:50 AM and Al Ekhbariya 11:53 AM); checked 12:54 PM

The Coalition spokesman said a cruise missile was intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah region. SPA and Al Ekhbariya relayed the statement. No casualties or debris damage reported so far.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid Intl Airport tells travellers to check flight status with their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:26 PM** · published 12:23–12:26 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 1:56 PM

Replying to passengers, KKIA asked travellers to contact their airline to confirm flight status and get updates. No reopening announced.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early-warning alerts in Najran then Jizan (~10:21–10:23 AM); danger cleared by ~10:26–10:27 AM**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **10:21 AM** · published 10:21–10:27 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:52 AM

Saudi Civil Defense issued National Early Warning Platform alerts for Najran City at 10:21 AM and Jizan City at 10:23 AM, then posted that the danger had passed in Najran at 10:26 AM and in Jizan at 10:27 AM. No Coalition intercept statement or casualty report was posted with these alerts. Continue following Civil Defense instructions; avoid gathering and filming.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: political writer Dr. Faisal Al-Sumairi says countries funding the Houthi militia with missiles must stop**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:49 PM** · published 12:49 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 1:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya: political writer Dr. Faisal Al-Sumairi says countries funding the Houthi militia with missiles must stop

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: senior scholar Sheikh Dr. Abdul-Ilah Al-Mulla says targeting Madinah is extremely grave and forbidden**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:36 PM** · published 1:36 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 1:56 PM

Al Ekhbariya: senior scholar Sheikh Dr. Abdul-Ilah Al-Mulla says targeting Madinah is extremely grave and forbidden

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense / Interior: filming or sharing missile and drone intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **10:28 AM** · published 10:28 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:52 AM

Saudi Civil Defense, citing the Interior Ministry, warned that filming, publishing, or sharing information related to countering missiles and drones and their impact sites exposes people to legal liability.

CONFIRMED **SPA: thunderstorms and flood risk forecast for southwest and western regions**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 7:55 AM

SPA carried a National Center for Meteorology outlook for moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and active winds over Jazan, Asir, Al-Baha and Makkah, and lighter to moderate rain over Medina, Hail, Tabuk, Al-Jouf, the Northern Borders and the Eastern Region. No airport closure linked to weather in the bulletin.

CONFIRMED **SPA: oil prices fall as investors assess supply outlook**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **6:51 AM** · published 6:51 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (SPA English); checked 7:55 AM

SPA English reported that oil prices fell as investors assessed the supply outlook. No new official link in the post to Red Sea or Hormuz transit disruption.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Coalition intercepted and destroyed a drone over the Eastern Region**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 AM** · published 5:59 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya relayed the coalition statement that a drone was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region. No casualties reported in the coalition line.

CONFIRMED **Saudi embassy in Bahrain helping citizens with disrupted flights get home, including by road**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:15 AM** · published 5:15 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported ongoing efforts by the Saudi embassy in Bahrain to help Saudi citizens whose flights were affected return home, including arranging land transport.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **4:13 AM** · published 4:13 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition spokesman, Arabic; SPA English 4:43 AM); checked 6:50 AM

The Coalition spokesman said a drone (UAV) was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region; first posted in Arabic at 4:13 AM by the Coalition spokesman and SPA, English release from SPA at 4:43 AM. No casualties or debris damage reported so far.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 1,250 Houthi fighters neutralised and more than 460 militia vehicles destroyed**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:35 AM** · published 2:35 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's armed forces said about 1,250 Houthi fighters had been neutralised and more than 460 militia military vehicles destroyed; the figures are the Yemeni forces' own and were not independently verified. No new attack, interception, Civil Defense alert or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 2:00 and 3:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Islamic Affairs Minister praises the armed forces' sacrifices in protecting the Kingdom**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:45 AM** · published 1:45 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Minister of Islamic Affairs Sheikh Dr. Abdullatif Al-Sheikh said the Kingdom will remain a nation of monotheism and pure creed, and that it values the great sacrifices of the armed forces in protecting the homeland. No new attack, interception or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 1:00 and 2:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi UN envoy in Geneva: Kingdom condemns repeated Houthi attacks and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:34 AM** · published 12:34 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Abdulmohsen bin Khuthaila, the Kingdom's permanent representative to the UN in Geneva, said Saudi Arabia condemns the Houthi terrorist militia's repeated attacks on its territory and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty and the security of citizens and residents under international law.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya correspondent in Yemen: 'Dawn of Yemen' operation escalating on Taiz, Marib and Lahj fronts**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:25 AM** · published 12:25 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent reported the 'Dawn of Yemen' operation is escalating quickly, with 24 hours of fighting on the northern and western fronts of Taiz city. He said the Houthi militia fired more than 1,000 mortar rounds at Jabal Han in 24 hours without a breakthrough. Battlefield claims are not independently verified.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport (KKIA) tells passengers to check flight status with their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:24 AM** · published 12:24 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account reply, Arabic, translated); checked 1:56 PM

Replying to a passenger, King Khalid International Airport said that for flight status or any updates, travellers should contact their airline, as the carrier is responsible for the flight. No reopening time was given.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Bahrain condemns Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and urges decisive Security Council measures**

SPA (@Spa_Eng, @SPAregions) · **11:56 PM Wed** · published 11:56 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (SPA English; Arabic 10:20 PM); checked 12:58 AM

The Saudi Press Agency reported that Bahrain strongly condemned the Houthi terrorist militia's attacks on Saudi Arabia and urged the UN Security Council to take decisive measures. It adds to the string of foreign condemnations carried by SPA since the airport strikes.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5426 min).

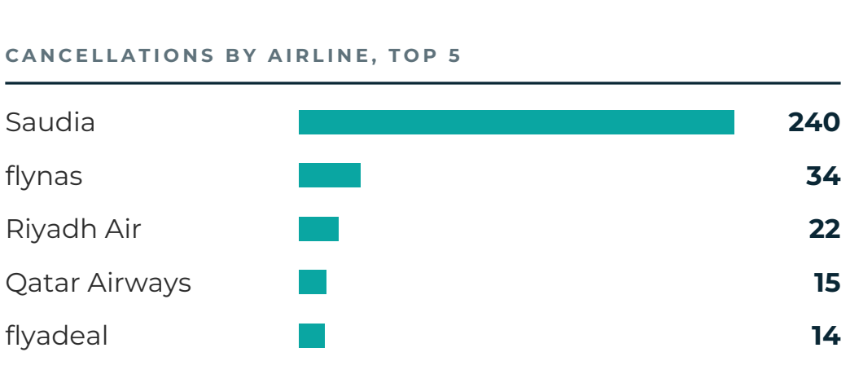
397	—	—	0	5
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
207 departures + 190 arrivals, 53% of 749 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Qassim, Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 3:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 395 at 3:55 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

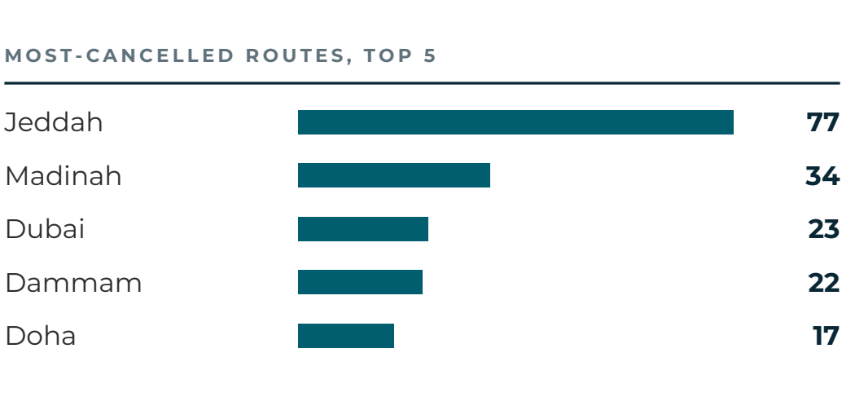
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	207	190	397	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	206 (54%)	189 (51%)	395	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	1 (0%)	1 (0%)	2	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	80 (99%)	68 (99%)	148	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 249	0 of 210	0 of 459	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	5	5	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	16	27	43	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	236	217	453	FR24 stats panel

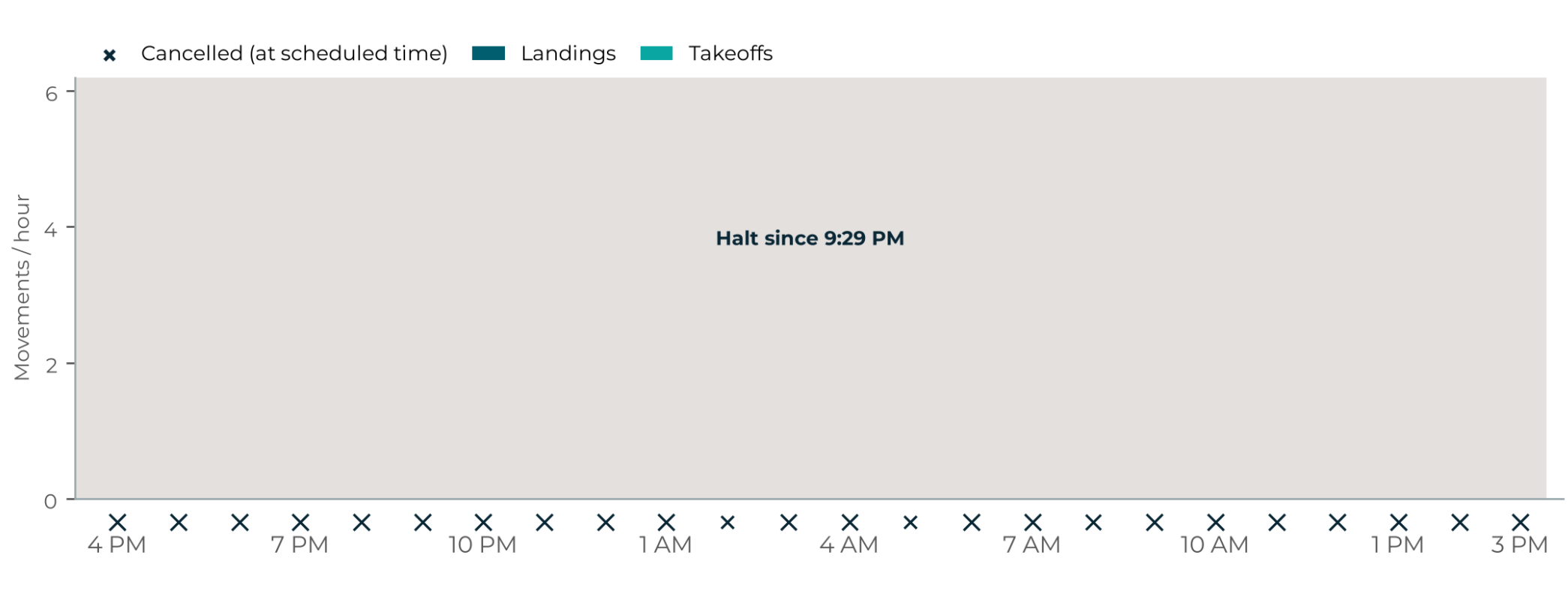
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



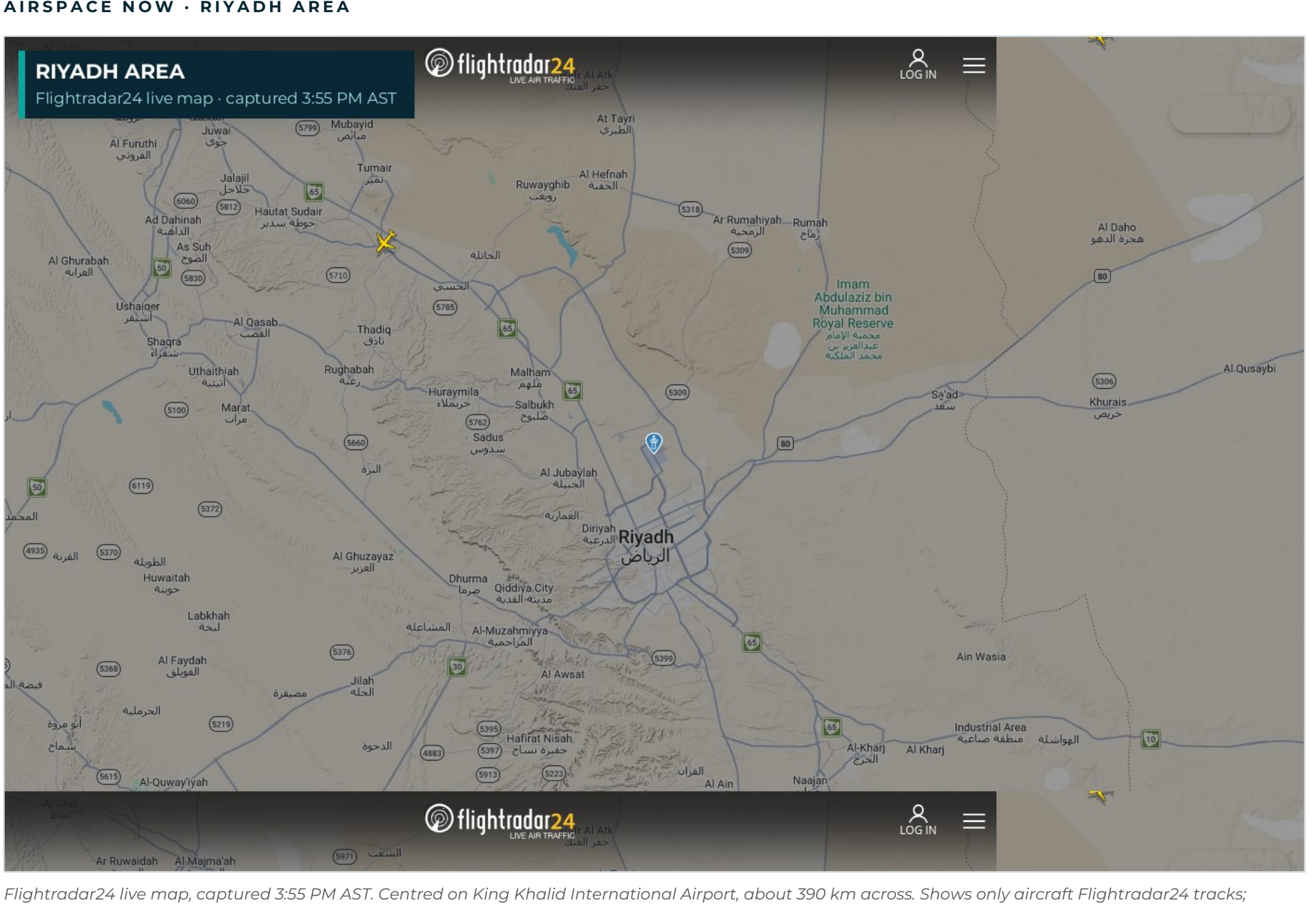
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 4:00 PM Wednesday to 3:55 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movement in it was SV1523 to Tabuk at 4:11 AM Wednesday. Dammam's 9:40–10:51 AM halt closed when F3304 departed for Jeddah.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	5426 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 3:55 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 5 takeoffs and 8 landings in the last hour.

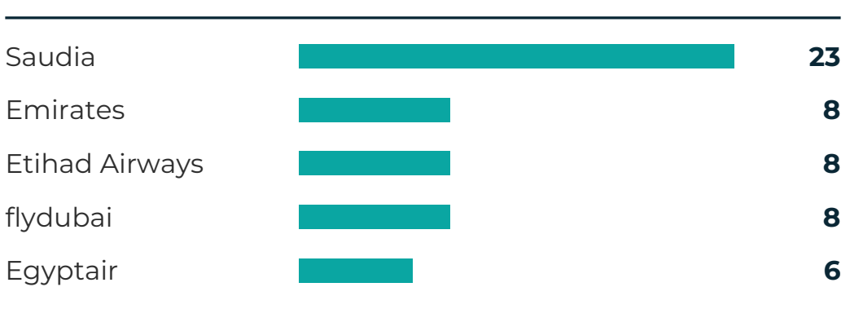
84	3:46 PM	3:48 PM	5	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
40 departures + 44 arrivals, 29% of 287 scheduled.	XY719 to Ha'il, 9 min before 3:55 PM.	XY740 from Abha, 7 min before 3:55 PM.	8 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Madinah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 3:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 84 at 3:55 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

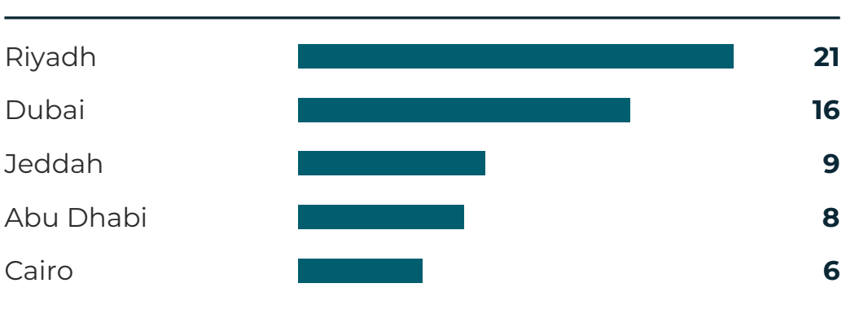
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	40	44	84	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	40 (28%)	44 (30%)	84	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	22 (15%)	18 (12%)	40	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	12 (35%)	15 (45%)	27	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	22 min	38 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	33 of 85	32 of 78	65 of 163	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	1	1	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	16	17	33	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	45	43	88	FR24 stats panel

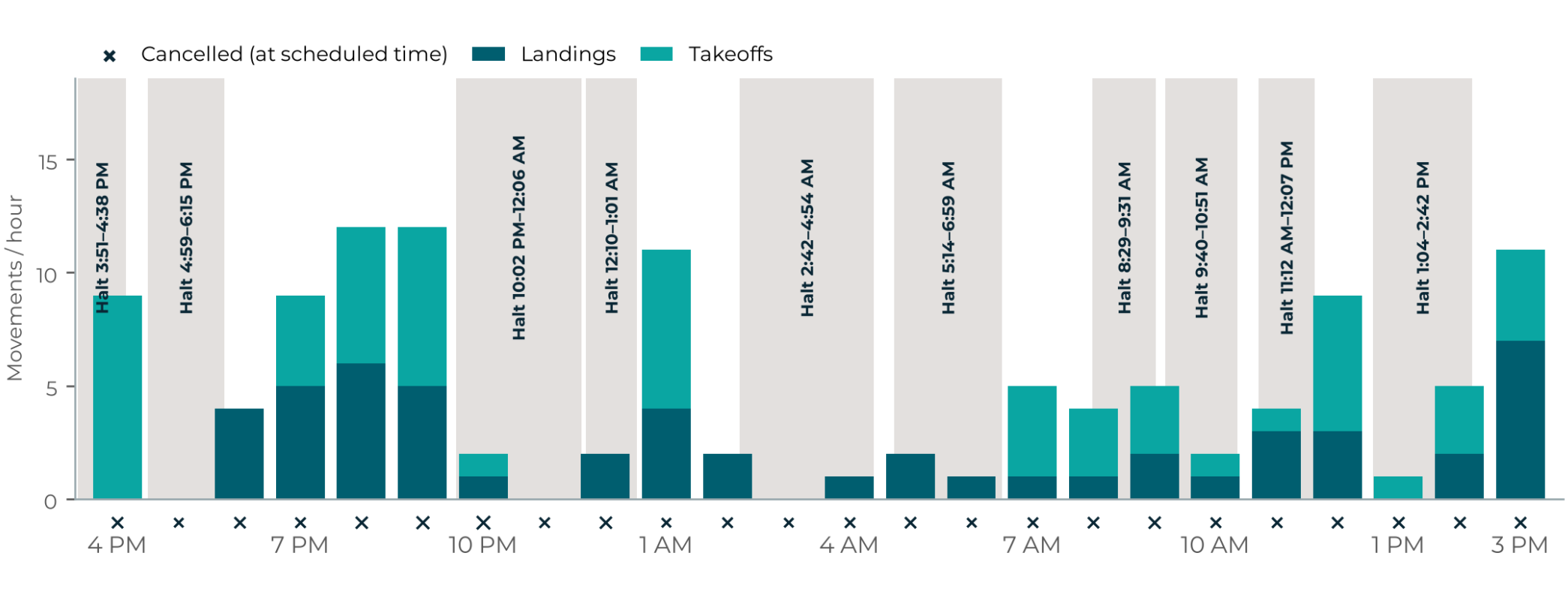
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (60) and landings (53) at DMM per hour from 4:00 PM Wednesday to 3:55 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

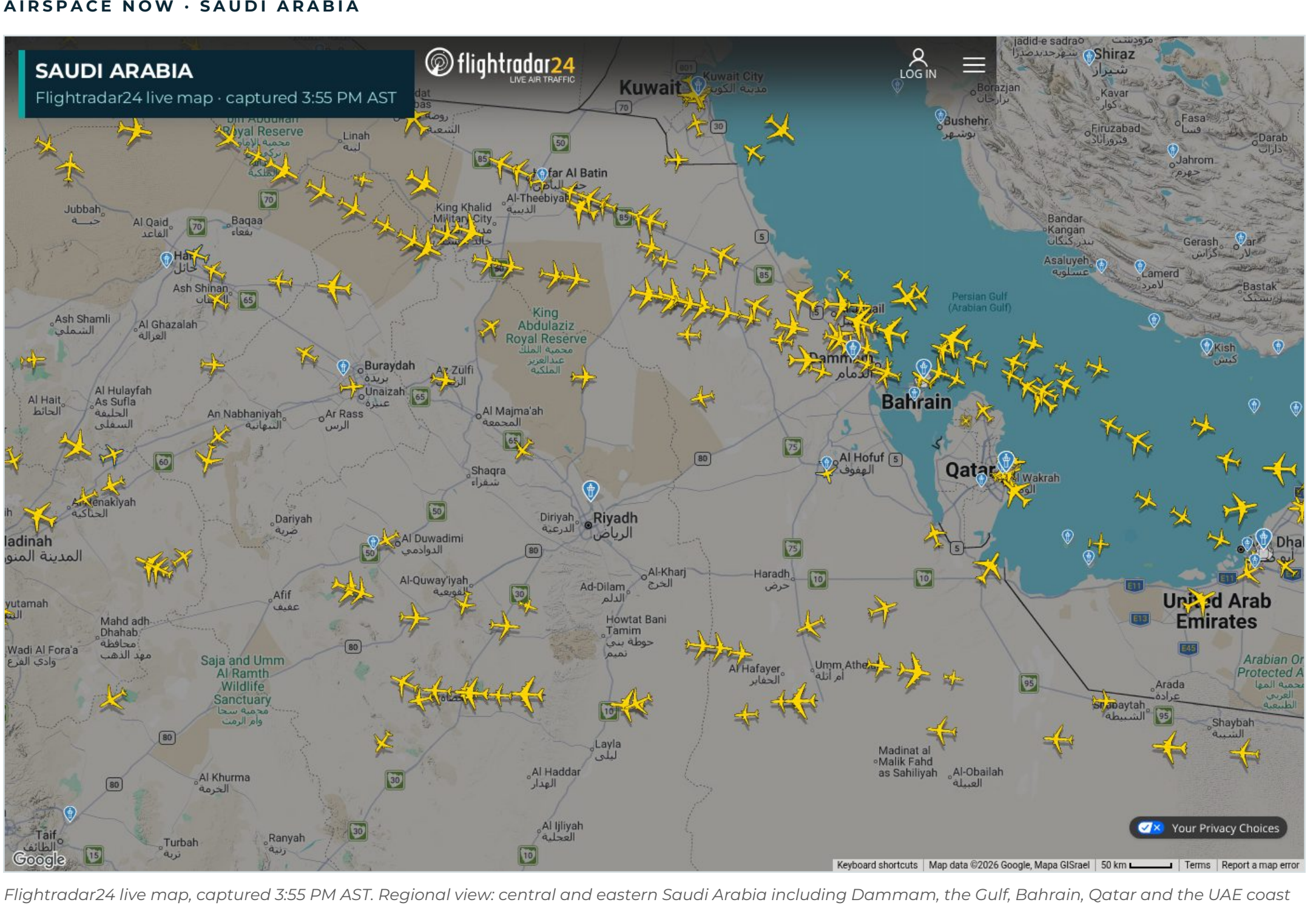
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 1:04–2:42 PM	98 min
Halt 11:12 AM–12:07 PM	55 min
Halt 9:40–10:51 AM	71 min
Halt 8:29–9:31 AM	62 min
Halt 5:14–6:59 AM	105 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (3:58 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



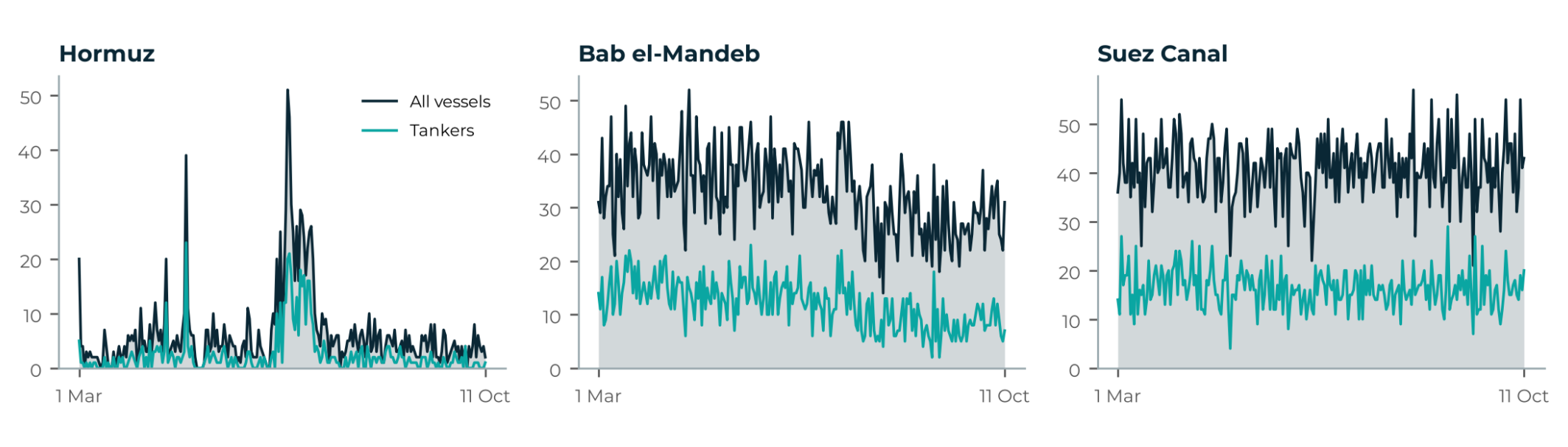
Flightradar24 live map, captured 3:55 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

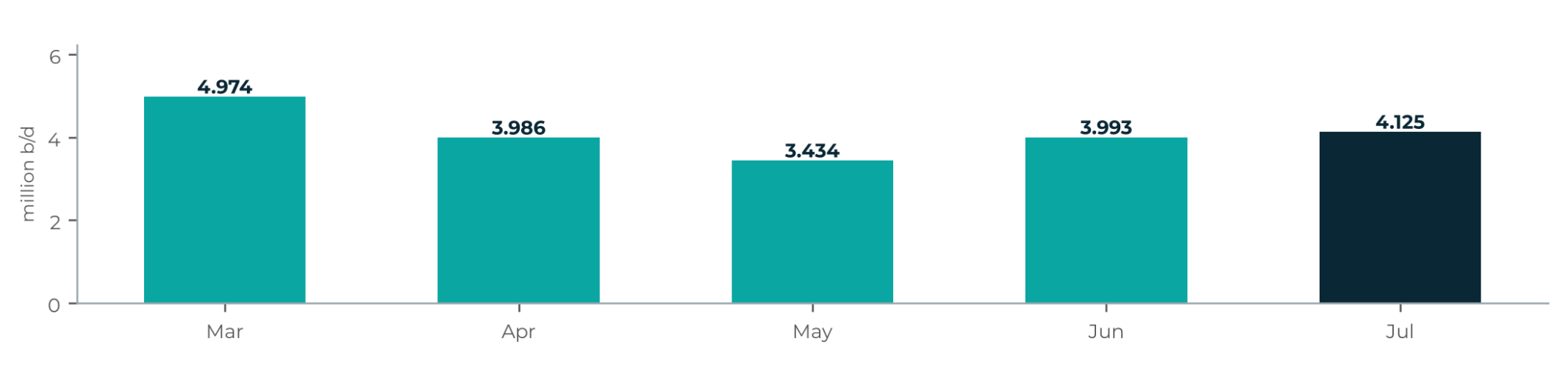
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 3:56 PM, Thu 15 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

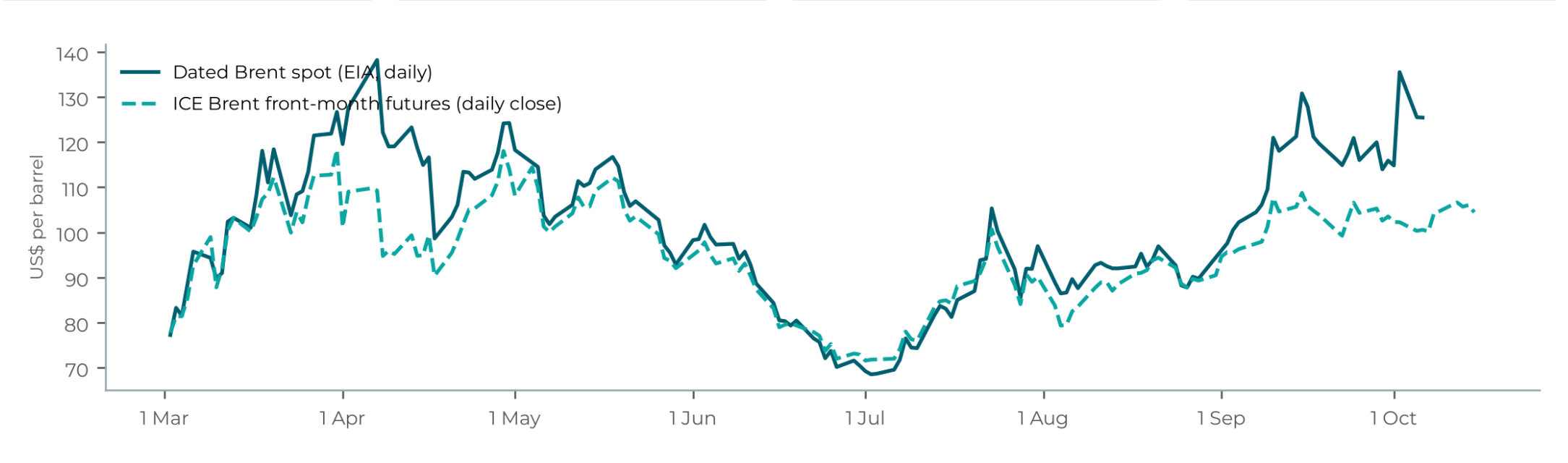


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$104.45	**$125.44**	**+23%**	**+62%**
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 3:46 PM, Thu 15 Oct AST (-1.5% on day). Near real time.	Tue 6 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $102.24 on Fri 4 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 3:55 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
3:55 PM, Thu 15 Oct	3:55 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	5:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 5:00 PM